10.9.3 The query_string query with a phrase

If you are wondering whether there's support for phrase searches using `query_string`, indeed there is. We can rewrite the code in listing 10.24 using a phrase rather than changing the operator. The only thing we need to note is that phrases must be enclosed in quotes. That means the quotes that correspond to the phrase must be escaped: for example, `"query": "\"Design Patterns\""`. The next query searches for a phrase.

Listing 10.25 A `query_string` query with a phrase

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "query_string": {
      "query": "\"making the code better\"",
      "default_field": "synopsis"
    }
  }
}
```

Quotes around the sentence make it a phrase query.

This code searches for the phrase `"making the code better"` in the `synopsis` field and fetches the book *Effective Java*. We can also use the `slop` parameter (discussed earlier in this chapter in section 10.5.2 and in chapter 8) if we are missing one or two words from the phrase. For example, the following listing shows how the `phrase_slop` parameter allows for a missing word in the phrase (*the* is dropped from the phrase) and still gets a successful result.

Listing 10.26 A `query_string` query with a phrase and `phrase_slop`

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "query_string": {
      "query": "\"making code better\"",
      "default_field": "synopsis",
      "phrase_slop": 1
    }
  }
}
```

The phrase with one word removed

Sets phrase_slop to 1 to honor the phrase with one missing

The query is missing a word, but the `phrase_slop` setting forgives the omission, and we get the desired result.

When building a search service, we must consider supporting spelling mistakes. Applications should handle these mistakes gracefully and, instead of returning incorrect or no results, identify the spelling issue to enhance and accommodate the results. This improves the user search experience. Elasticsearch provides support for handling incorrect spelling through *fuzzy queries*.